Julius Felix Weiske

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Research Profile

Social scientist working at the intersection of political communication, political psychology and computational social science. Combines experimental and survey research with large-scale platform data, NLP-based text analysis and research software development. Research interests include political judgment, information integrity, democratic resilience and the societal effects of AI.

Education

M.A. Political Communication | Friedrich Schiller University Jena

Oct 2026 – present

B.A. Communication Science | Friedrich Schiller University Jena

Oct 2022 – Aug 2026

Final grade: 1.7 (German grading scale).

Minor in **Psychology** (approximately 60 ECTS).

Thesis: *On the Role of Recognition of Judgment Competence: Relationality as a Factor in Ideological Bias Expression.*

Thesis grade: 1.3

Preregistered randomized online experiment (N = 856); study design, SoSci Survey implementation, panel coordination with Bilendi, analysis in R and visualization. Signal detection theory, regression, planned contrasts and equivalence testing. Poster presented at the DGPs Congress 2026, Luxembourg.

Additional studies in Sociology and Philosophy: approximately 35 ECTS at Friedrich Schiller University Jena (current average grade: 1.0); studied theory of knowledge, modal logic and rhetoric as well as social theory and theory of work and gender.

Research and Professional Experience

Student Research Assistant | SensipoV, Friedrich Schiller University Jena

Oct 2024 - present

BMBF-funded project on political bias in scientific evidence evaluation at the chair of Media and Communication Psychology.

- Supported literature reviews, questionnaire testing, study preparation and data exports; contributed to research, fact curation, testing and quality assurance for both the Fakt-o-Mat and youth Fakt-o-Mat.
- Supported and developed analyses evaluating the *Ideological Bias Expression* Scale. Tested different SDT-approaches to measure competence and bias with Bayesian and frequentist modelling.
- Set up and maintained a self-hosted formr research infrastructure, including user management, updates and troubleshooting.
- Developed a custom fork of formr using AI-assisted development workflows, integrating OpenAI and Anthropic language models into survey questionnaires. Implemented an interactive AI chat item with configurable conversation and response-length constraints, administrator controls for models and usage limits, and structured JSON exports of participant–AI conversations.

Research Intern and Student Research Assistant | KomRex, Friedrich Schiller University Jena

Intern: Apr 2025 - Aug 2025 | Research assistant: Aug 2025 - Mar 2026

- Conceptual development, methodological design and computational analysis on a first-author contribution to Thüringer Zustände 2025 on populist communication in the AfD's Telegram environment.
- Contributed to qualitative and quantitative research, coding schemes and empirical evaluation of NGOs; supported eight student science-communication projects.
- Development of *Resiliente Wissenschaft*, a resource addressing hostility towards researchers; supported public dialogue and science-communication events.

Publications and Conference Contributions

Weiske, J., Bojarskich, V., & Kauk, J. (2026). Im digitalen Umfeld der AfD in Thüringen – Populistische Kommunikation auf Telegram im Bundestagswahljahr 2025 [In the AfD's digital orbit in Thuringia: Populist communication on Telegram in the 2025 federal election year]. In ezra, MOBIT e. V., KomRex, & IDZ Jena (Eds.), *Thüringer Zustände 2025: Rechtsextremismus und gruppenbezogene Menschenfeindlichkeit im Freistaat Thüringen* (pp. 25–32). www.thueringer-zustaende.de

Weiske, J. (accepted). Schreiben oder schreiben lassen? Eine systematische Analyse der Glaubwürdigkeitswahrnehmung von KI-Journalismus [Who Does the Writing? A Systematic Review of the Perceived Credibility of AI-Generated Journalism]. *Licht & Wissen.*

Weiske, J., Finn, C., Stolp, A., & Rothmund, T. (2026). *Zur Rolle kommunikativer Subjektaffirmation: Relationalität als Faktor der Ideological Bias Expression* [The role of communicative subject affirmation: Relationality as a factor in ideological bias expression] DGPs Congress 2026, Luxembourg. [Poster presentation].

Research Outputs

Harth, L.*, & **Weiske, J.* (2026)**. *Resiliente Wissenschaft: Schutzmaßnahmen, Ressourcen und Anlaufstellen zum Umgang mit wissenschaftsfeindlichen Angriffen.* KomRex, Friedrich Schiller University Jena. [Research and design; CC BY 4.0]. See here.

* Contributed equally.

Selected Research and Software Projects

Populist Communication on Telegram | 2025 - 2026

Collected and processed approximately 80,000 messages from 101 channels in the AfD's Thüringen environment. Implemented PopBERT classification, statistical and temporal analyses, and visualization. Published first-author contribution in Thüringer Zustände 2025.

Fakt-o-Mat Live | 2026

Developed an interactive science-communication application in FastAPI and JavaScript, adapting an existing research instrument on ideologically biased evidence evaluation (IBE Scale) for moderated presentations and autonomous poster sessions.

Implemented on-device scoring of discrimination sensitivity and ideological bias, private feedback with reference-sample percentile comparisons, and live group visualisations. Designed a data-minimising architecture and minimum group thresholds. See here.

AI Journalism and Perceived Credibility | 2025

Sole-author systematic review: systematic search, PRISMA-based study selection, structured coding and narrative synthesis. LLM-assisted extraction with manual verification and correction. Accepted for publication in Licht & Wissen.

Rejections and Unfinished Projects

In the spirit of transparency, I have chosen to include selected unsuccessful applications and submissions to my CV. Rejections are no small part of academic work, which is why my aim is to make this part of my academic trajectory visible alongside completed projects and published work.

Honours Program, Friedrich Schiller University Jena | 2025
Application unsuccessful. Proposed an online experiment examining whether resonance-oriented perspective-taking could reduce ideologically biased evaluation of evidence, connecting Hartmut Rosa's resonance theory with political psychology. Applied for programme participation and support for participant recruitment and conference attendance. The proposal was subsequently revised and developed into my bachelor's thesis.

Twitch and Populism | 2025 - 2026
Collaborative project; approximately 970,000 transcript segments from about 22 DACH streamers. Project paused after no sufficiently robust patterns emerged.

Methods and Technical Skills

Quantitative methods: Experimental and survey design; preregistration; regression and ANOVA; moderation; planned contrasts; equivalence testing; robust inference; diagnostics; power analysis; signal detection theory, including Bayesian HMeta-d and statconfr applications.

Computational methods and synthesis: platform-data collection; transformer-based text classification; temporal text analysis; systematic review and PRISMA; scientific visualization.

Programming and infrastructure: Practical, project-based experience with Python (PopBERT, BERTopic), R, JavaScript, Bash, Git/GitHub and Linux. AI-assisted development workflows; server administration.

Research tools: SoSci Survey, Unipark, formr, RStudio, VS Code and Zotero.

Teaching, Service and Public Engagement

Teaching and workshops: Designed and delivered a Unipark introduction for students. Delivered two science communication workshops for bachelor's and master's students and supported workshops on racism and group-focused enmity in educational contexts.

Academic service: Peer reviewer, Licht & Wissen (since Jul 2026); Finance Officer, Communication Science Student Council (Oct 2023 - Sep 2024).

Languages

German (native); English (C1, scientific working proficiency); French (B1); Spanish (A1).